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## Internship Reflections

During my internship at Merazine I had the opportunity to work as a Social Media Content Creator, contributing roughly 8 to 9 hours a week over several months. Merazine is a platform that bridges fashion, technology, and sustainability by creating a space for users to discover responsible brands, stay informed on sustainable fashion practices, and engage with curated content that reflects evolving cultural and consumer values. It's built around the belief that fashion should be both stylish and conscious, as Merazine aims to empower users to shop more mindfully and stay connected to trends without compromising their values. I reached out to one of the founders expressing my interest in the vision and my passion for creating content. We had a few interviews and I was given the job. When I joined, the company was in its foundational stage, building its brand identity, digital presence, and product offering from the ground up. As part of a small, focused team, I was entrusted with helping shape Merazine's social media strategy, content execution, and overall narrative.

My primary responsibility was to create engaging content that would resonate with Merazine's target audience: fashion-savvy, sustainability-oriented consumers. The majority of my time was spent conceptualizing content ideas, shooting, editing, and uploading on social media platforms like Instagram and TikTok. My focus was not just on aesthetics, but on providing value on how to help users decide where to buy sustainable fashion, how to style sustainably, and how Merazine's platform could help them achieve this. I was also up-to-date with the latest trends, not merely fashion trends, but how social content was evolving, using this

research to constantly make Merazine's content fresh and culturally relevant. Each week, I received thoughtful feedback from the founders that allowed me to tune both the strategic and creative elements of my work. This feedback loop was one of the most educational parts of the internship because it taught me how to iterate on concepts, take criticism well, and continually improve based on performance and audience reaction.

One of the biggest surprises for me was realizing just how challenging content creation really is. On the surface, creating social media posts might seem straightforward, but in reality, every piece of content goes through a demanding process. Ideation requires a strong understanding of audience psychology and branding. Filming demands attention to detail, visual storytelling, and planning. Editing takes time and technical skill to ensure the final product is polished, engaging, and aligned with the brand's tone. I quickly learned that executing a creative vision is far from easy. It requires discipline, patience, and an openness to creative influence. At the same time, it was incredibly rewarding to see how inspiration could come from anywhere: a Pinterest mood board, a color palette in a music video, or a storytelling technique in a short film. These sources became fuel for shaping a unique voice and visual language for Merazine, something that made the creative process feel personal and meaningful.

The other fundamental learning experience was the day-to-day collaboration with a small, tight-knit group. Since Merazine was still a startup, everyone wore multiple hats, and I was encouraged to share ideas, experiment with formats, and think beyond my title. I learned what it's like to build something from the ground up, make branding decisions, how trust with an audience is established, and how every piece of communication contributes to the greater mission. This environment enabled me to solidify my communication and time management skills and, more importantly, to feel more confident in my professional identity. Before this

internship, I hadn't fully experienced what it was like to work in a fast-paced, mission-driven team. Now I have a better idea of how to work in the workplace, take initiative, receive and give feedback, and drive forward even when things are not perfect.

Throughout the rest of my career, I will be using several lessons learned from this experience on future job interviews and workspaces. I have learned to operate individually but stay aligned with a team's goals, how to take criticism seriously without getting discouraged, and how to balance creativity with planning. I also feel that I've developed a strong professional foundation, from how to behave in meetings, to how to ask the right questions, to how to represent a brand with intention and clarity. These are all soft skills that are difficult to teach in a classroom, but crucial in the real world.

In relation to the EMPAC model, this internship touched upon each element. Entrepreneurship was at the forefront of everything we were doing, as each person on the team was focused on launching something original and value-driven. My role was most closely aligned with marketing, where I not only created content but also helped think strategically about how we could reach and grow our audience. I gained knowledge of the product from working on Merazine's platform and aiding in brainstorming ways to sell it to users. I gained an understanding of how to understand basic analytics such as likes, shares, engagement rates, and use them to guide future content. And finally, the company culture at Merazine was one of mentorship, innovation, and transparency that allowed me to grow not just as a marketer, but as a partner and young professional.

Overall, my Merazine internship was a transformative experience that enabled me to acquire hard and soft skills essential to a career in fashion, tech, and digital media. It made me appreciate the value of branding, taught me the reality of content creation, and gave me

first-hand experience with startup culture. Most importantly, perhaps, it enabled me to determine what kind of professional I want to be collaborative, curious, adaptable, and meaningful.